

SnowyKim Recruitment and Hiring Policy

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Policy Owner: Human Resources

Approved By: Director of Human Resources

Applies To: All SnowyKim hiring activity, including positions connected to the San Francisco and New York City offices

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1. Purpose

SnowyKim is committed to conducting recruitment and hiring in a consistent, fair, job-related, and legally compliant manner.

This policy establishes standards for:

- Creating and approving positions
 - Drafting job descriptions
 - Advertising job opportunities
 - Sourcing and referring candidates
 - Reviewing applications
 - Conducting interviews
 - Administering assessments
 - Using artificial intelligence and automated hiring tools
 - Providing applicant accommodations
 - Conducting background checks
 - Selecting candidates
 - Preparing and approving employment offers
 - Protecting candidate information
 - Documenting hiring decisions
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2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Recruiters
- Hiring managers
- Interviewers
- Human Resources personnel
- Executives

- Employees participating in candidate evaluation
- Employee-referral participants
- Temporary staffing agencies
- External recruiters
- Background-check providers
- Assessment vendors
- Technology vendors supporting recruitment

The policy applies to:

- Regular full-time positions
- Regular part-time positions
- Temporary positions
- Internships
- Contract-to-hire positions
- Internal promotions
- Internal transfers
- Remote and hybrid positions
- Rehiring former employees

3. Equal Employment Opportunity

SnowyKim makes recruitment and hiring decisions based on legitimate, job-related factors such as:

- Relevant skills
- Experience
- Education or training
- Work samples
- Demonstrated competencies
- Ability to perform the position's essential functions
- Business requirements
- Interview and assessment results

SnowyKim prohibits discrimination against applicants based on characteristics protected by applicable federal, state, or local law.

Protected characteristics may include:

- Race
- Color
- Religion or creed
- National origin
- Ancestry
- Sex
- Pregnancy
- Childbirth or related medical conditions

- Sexual orientation
- Gender
- Gender identity
- Gender expression
- Age
- Disability
- Medical condition
- Genetic information
- Marital or partnership status
- Military or veteran status
- Citizenship or immigration status, where protected
- Caregiver status, where protected
- Status as a victim of domestic violence, sexual violence, or stalking
- Any other legally protected status

Recruiters and interviewers must not consider a protected characteristic when making hiring recommendations.

Federal law also prohibits hiring practices that intentionally discriminate or that improperly screen out protected groups when the requirement is not necessary and job-related.

4. Recruitment Responsibilities

4.1 Human Resources

Human Resources is responsible for:

- Reviewing and approving requisitions
- Confirming job classifications
- Reviewing job descriptions
- Confirming approved compensation ranges
- Coordinating postings
- Advising on lawful interview practices
- Supporting accommodations
- Maintaining recruiting records
- Coordinating background checks
- Preparing or approving employment offers
- Monitoring compliance with this policy

4.2 Hiring Managers

Hiring managers are responsible for:

- Identifying a legitimate staffing need
- Defining the position's essential responsibilities
- Identifying necessary qualifications

- Participating in candidate evaluation
- Using approved selection criteria
- Completing feedback promptly
- Avoiding unauthorized promises to candidates
- Protecting candidate confidentiality

4.3 Interviewers

Interviewers are responsible for:

- Reviewing the approved role criteria
- Asking job-related questions
- Evaluating assigned competencies
- Providing factual written feedback
- Avoiding prohibited questions
- Disclosing conflicts of interest
- Maintaining confidentiality

4.4 Recruiters

Recruiters are responsible for:

- Maintaining consistent candidate communication
- Reviewing applicants according to approved criteria
- Providing interview guidance
- Monitoring candidate progression
- Identifying potential compliance concerns
- Ensuring approved notices and disclosures are provided
- Documenting hiring stages

5. Job Requisition Approval

A position may not be posted or actively recruited for until an authorized job requisition has been approved.

The requisition should identify:

- Job title
- Department
- Hiring manager
- Employment type
- Work location
- Remote or hybrid expectations
- Full-time or part-time status
- Exempt or nonexempt classification
- Proposed compensation range
- Budget approval

- Target start date
- Business reason for the opening
- Replacement or newly created position status
- Required approvals

Human Resources may return a requisition for correction if:

- The position lacks budget approval
- The responsibilities are unclear
- The qualifications are unnecessarily restrictive
- The compensation range is unsupported
- The classification appears inaccurate
- The position duplicates an existing opening
- The proposed process presents a legal or policy concern

6. Job Descriptions

Every opening must have an approved job description.

A job description should include:

- Position title
- Department
- Reporting relationship
- Work location
- Employment type
- Position summary
- Essential responsibilities
- Required qualifications
- Preferred qualifications
- Relevant technical or professional skills
- Work-schedule expectations
- Travel expectations, where applicable
- Physical or operational requirements that are genuinely job-related
- Approved compensation range
- Equal employment opportunity statement

6.1 Required and Preferred Qualifications

Required qualifications must be necessary to perform the role successfully.

Preferred qualifications may be used to distinguish candidates but should not be presented as mandatory.

Hiring teams must avoid:

- Inflated years-of-experience requirements

- Unnecessary degree requirements
- Physical requirements unrelated to essential duties
- Language requirements unrelated to business needs
- Cultural or personality criteria that function as proxies for protected characteristics
- Requirements designed around a predetermined individual rather than the position

6.2 Essential Functions

Essential functions should describe the fundamental duties of the position.

They should be written so that SnowyKim can:

- Evaluate candidate qualifications
- Support disability-accommodation discussions
- Establish performance expectations
- Distinguish essential duties from marginal tasks

7. Job Postings

All external job postings must be approved by Human Resources.

Postings must accurately identify:

- Job title
- Key responsibilities
- Required qualifications
- Preferred qualifications
- Work location
- Remote or hybrid expectations
- Compensation information required by applicable law
- Whether compensation includes commissions, where applicable
- Instructions for requesting an accommodation
- Equal employment opportunity language

Postings must not contain:

- Discriminatory preferences
 - Age-coded language
 - Gender preferences, except where legally permitted
 - Unnecessary citizenship requirements
 - Salary-history questions
 - Criminal-history questions that are prohibited before a conditional offer
 - Misleading compensation ranges
 - Requirements that do not reflect the actual position
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8. Pay Transparency

8.1 California Positions

For job postings covered by California law, the posting must include the position's pay scale when required.

The pay scale must reflect the salary or hourly wage range SnowyKim reasonably expects to pay for the position.

California employers with at least 15 employees must include the pay scale in covered job postings, including postings distributed through third parties.

8.2 New York Positions

For covered New York opportunities, SnowyKim must include a good-faith compensation range in advertisements for jobs, promotions, and transfers.

The posting must also state when compensation is commission-based.

New York's requirements can apply to opportunities performed at least partly in New York and certain remote positions reporting to a New York office or supervisor.

8.3 Compensation Range Standards

The listed range must:

- Be approved before posting
- Reflect the expected minimum and maximum base compensation
- Be stated in good faith
- Not be artificially broad to avoid meaningful disclosure
- Be updated when the approved range materially changes
- Be communicated to staffing agencies and third-party recruiters

Benefits, bonuses, commissions, equity, or other compensation may be described separately from base pay.

9. Salary-History Restrictions

Recruiters, managers, interviewers, vendors, and other hiring participants must not ask applicants about current or previous compensation when prohibited by law.

Prohibited inquiries include questions about:

- Previous salary
- Current salary
- Past bonuses

- Prior commissions
- Previous benefits
- Prior equity awards
- Total compensation at another employer

Hiring teams may ask:

- What compensation range are you seeking?
- Does the posted range align with your expectations?
- Are there particular compensation components that are important to you?

California prohibits employers from seeking an applicant's salary history and permits questions about salary expectations instead.

New York City employers may not ask about or rely on an applicant's salary history during the hiring process.

When an applicant voluntarily mentions prior compensation, the interviewer should redirect the discussion toward:

- The approved compensation range
- The applicant's qualifications
- The responsibilities of the position
- The applicant's expectations

10. Candidate Sourcing

Candidates may be sourced through:

- SnowyKim's careers page
- Public job boards
- Professional networks
- Universities
- Industry associations
- Employee referrals
- Approved staffing agencies
- Approved search firms
- Internal talent programs

Recruitment sources should be selected to support broad, job-related access to opportunities.

Hiring teams must not:

- Restrict sourcing to groups defined by protected characteristics
- Exclude qualified applicants because they are not part of a manager's personal network
- Use coded sourcing criteria designed to exclude protected groups

- Direct recruiters to produce candidates of a particular race, sex, age, or other protected status
- Use personal social-media information unrelated to the position

Efforts to broaden applicant outreach must remain consistent with laws prohibiting employment decisions based on protected characteristics.

11. Employee Referrals

SnowyKim may accept employee referrals.

Referring employees may provide:

- Candidate name
- Contact information
- Résumé or professional profile
- Description of how they know the candidate
- Relevant professional context

Referring employees must not:

- Access confidential candidate records
- Pressure the hiring team
- Participate in the process without authorization
- Promise an interview or offer
- Receive confidential interview feedback
- Misrepresent their relationship with the candidate

Referral status does not guarantee an interview, preferential treatment, or employment.

Referral bonuses, when offered, are governed by the applicable referral program.

12. Conflicts of Interest

Hiring participants must disclose when a candidate is:

- A family member
- A current or former romantic partner
- A close personal friend
- A current business partner
- A person with whom the participant has a significant financial relationship
- A person involved in an unresolved personal dispute
- A former direct report whose evaluation may not be impartial

Human Resources will determine whether the participant should:

- Be removed from the process
- Have a limited role
- Provide factual information only
- Continue with documented safeguards

Failure to disclose a significant conflict may result in corrective action.

13. Application Review

Applications must be evaluated against approved, job-related criteria.

Reviewers should consider:

- Whether minimum qualifications are met
- Relevant experience
- Demonstrated technical or professional skills
- Work samples
- Certifications or licenses, where required
- Transferable experience
- Ability to perform essential functions with or without reasonable accommodation

Reviewers must not consider:

- A candidate's photograph
- Protected personal characteristics
- Assumptions based on a candidate's name
- Graduation year as a proxy for age
- Marital or parental status
- Disability-related information
- Personal social-media content unrelated to the role
- Salary history
- Criminal history before the stage permitted by law

Selection criteria should be applied consistently to applicants for the same position.

14. Interview Process

SnowyKim generally uses structured or semi-structured interviews.

Each interview should evaluate one or more approved competencies, such as:

- Technical knowledge
- Analytical ability

- Communication
- Collaboration
- Leadership
- Customer judgment
- Project management
- Adaptability
- Role-specific expertise

Candidates for the same role should be assessed using substantially similar core criteria.

Follow-up questions may vary based on the candidate's answers and experience.

15. Permitted Interview Questions

Interviewers may ask questions such as:

- Tell me about your experience using the tools required for this role.
- Describe a relevant project you completed.
- How would you approach this job-related scenario?
- Are you able to perform the essential functions of this role with or without reasonable accommodation?
- Are you legally authorized to work in the United States?
- Will you now or in the future require employment sponsorship?
- Are you able to meet the position's stated scheduling requirements?
- Are you able to travel at the level identified in the job description?
- What compensation range are you seeking?

Work-authorization questions must be asked consistently and must not be used as a proxy for national-origin discrimination.

16. Prohibited Interview Questions

Interviewers must not ask about:

- Race or ethnicity
- Religion or religious practices, except through an appropriate accommodation process
- National origin or ancestry
- Native language, unless language ability is job-related
- Age or date of birth
- Graduation year when used to estimate age
- Marital status
- Pregnancy
- Plans to become pregnant
- Childcare arrangements
- Number or ages of children

- Sexual orientation
- Gender identity
- Medical history
- Disability history
- Workers' compensation history
- Genetic information
- Family medical history
- Prior salary
- Political beliefs
- Union membership
- Protected complaints or legal activity
- Criminal history before legally permitted

An interviewer who receives unsolicited protected information should not pursue it and should not include it in the hiring recommendation.

17. Reasonable Accommodations for Applicants

SnowyKim will provide reasonable accommodations to qualified applicants when required by law.

Applicants may request accommodations for:

- Interviews
- Tests
- Work samples
- Application platforms
- Communication formats
- Physical access
- Scheduling related to disability, pregnancy, or religious observance
- Other covered needs

Accommodation requests should be directed to Human Resources.

Recruiters and interviewers should receive only the information necessary to implement the accommodation.

They generally should not receive:

- The applicant's diagnosis
- Complete medical records
- Unrelated health history
- Detailed treatment information

Federal law may require reasonable accommodations for qualified applicants based on disability, religion, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions.

18. Candidate Assessments

Assessments may include:

- Skills tests
- Technical exercises
- Writing samples
- Work simulations
- Presentations
- Case studies
- Structured questionnaires
- Job-related cognitive or physical assessments

Before use, Human Resources should determine whether the assessment:

- Measures a skill relevant to the role
- Is appropriate for the position level
- Can be administered consistently
- Allows reasonable accommodation
- Avoids unnecessary collection of sensitive information
- Has been reviewed for potential adverse impact
- Does not impose excessive unpaid work

Assessments must not be designed to obtain usable free labor from candidates.

Candidates should not be asked to solve an active confidential business problem when the resulting work could be used commercially without compensation.

19. Artificial Intelligence and Automated Hiring Tools

SnowyKim may not use an artificial intelligence, algorithmic, or automated hiring tool unless it has been approved by Human Resources, Legal, Privacy, and Information Security as appropriate.

Potential tools include:

- Résumé-screening systems
- Candidate-ranking tools
- Automated interview scoring
- Video or voice-analysis software
- Skills-assessment scoring
- Candidate-matching systems
- Chatbots that recommend candidate progression

Approved use must include:

- A documented business purpose

- A clear description of the tool's function
- Human oversight
- Testing for accuracy and potential discriminatory impact
- Vendor review
- Data-security review
- Candidate notices where required
- An accommodation process
- Procedures for challenging or reviewing results
- Retention limits

The tool must not make an unreviewed final hiring decision.

Recruiters and hiring managers remain responsible for the decision and may not rely blindly on automated scores.

California's employment-discrimination regulations apply existing civil-rights protections to automated decision systems used in employment.

For covered New York City use, an automated employment decision tool may require a recent bias audit, public audit information, and advance candidate notices.

20. Interview Feedback

Interview feedback must be:

- Submitted through an approved system
- Completed promptly
- Based on observed evidence
- Related to assigned competencies
- Written independently when requested
- Free of protected-characteristic references
- Professional and factual

Appropriate feedback:

The candidate clearly explained the data pipeline but did not demonstrate experience troubleshooting production failures.

Inappropriate feedback:

She may not fit the young culture of the team.

Interviewers should avoid vague phrases such as:

- Not a culture fit
- Too aggressive

- Too quiet
- Not polished
- Seems old-school
- Would not fit with the team

Such phrases must be connected to a specific, job-related competency to be considered.

21. Hiring Decisions

The final selection should be based on:

- Approved qualifications
- Interview evidence
- Assessment results
- Relevant work experience
- References, where applicable
- Business needs
- Ability to perform essential functions
- Approved compensation parameters

Hiring decisions must not be based on:

- Protected characteristics
- Personal favoritism
- A manager's undisclosed relationship with the candidate
- Salary history
- Unverified rumors
- Personal social-media content unrelated to the position
- A candidate's request for accommodation
- A candidate's protected complaint or legal activity

Human Resources may pause or reject a hiring decision that is insufficiently documented or appears inconsistent with policy.

22. Background Checks

Background checks may be conducted only:

- For approved positions
- Through an approved provider
- At the stage permitted by applicable law
- With required authorization and disclosures
- Using job-related criteria
- With appropriate review before adverse action

Depending on the role, a check may include:

- Employment verification
- Education verification
- Professional-license verification
- Criminal-history information
- Driving records
- Reference checks
- Other legally permitted information

SnowyKim must comply with applicable federal, state, and local restrictions.

22.1 California Fair Chance Requirements

For covered California hiring, SnowyKim generally must not ask about or consider conviction history before making a conditional offer.

When considering conviction information after an offer, SnowyKim must follow the required individualized review and notice process before withdrawing the offer.

22.2 Adverse Action

Before taking adverse action based on a background report, SnowyKim will provide required notices and an opportunity for the candidate to review or respond where required.

Final decisions must be approved by Human Resources.

23. Reference Checks

Reference checks may be conducted only by authorized personnel.

Questions should relate to:

- Dates of employment
- Job title
- Responsibilities
- Relevant skills
- Work performance
- Rehire eligibility, where appropriate
- Other job-related matters

Reference checkers must not ask about:

- Protected characteristics
- Medical conditions
- Family status

- Salary history where prohibited
- Protected complaints
- Information unrelated to the candidate's suitability for the role

SnowyKim must not contact a candidate's current employer without the candidate's authorization.

24. Employment Offers

Only authorized Human Resources personnel may issue or approve an employment offer.

An offer should identify:

- Job title
- Department
- Manager
- Work location
- Start date
- Employment status
- Compensation
- Pay frequency
- Bonus or commission eligibility
- Equity eligibility, where applicable
- Benefits eligibility
- Work-schedule expectations
- Conditions of the offer
- Required acknowledgments
- At-will employment language where applicable

Managers must not make verbal promises regarding:

- Guaranteed employment duration
 - Guaranteed promotion
 - Guaranteed bonus
 - Guaranteed remote-work status
 - Compensation outside the approved range
 - Immigration outcomes
 - Severance
 - Special benefits
 - Unapproved schedule arrangements
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25. Conditional Offers

An offer may be conditioned on legally permitted requirements such as:

- Verification of work authorization

- Completion of a background check
- Verification of credentials
- Professional licensing
- Reference checks
- Compliance with lawful job requirements
- Execution of required agreements

Conditions must be stated clearly and applied consistently.

A conditional offer may not be withdrawn without Human Resources review.

26. Immigration and Work Authorization

SnowyKim will verify employment authorization as required by law.

Recruiters may ask whether an applicant:

- Is legally authorized to work in the United States
- Will require current or future employment sponsorship

Recruiters must not ask:

- Where the applicant was born
- How the applicant became a citizen
- Whether the applicant is a “real” citizen
- Questions intended to identify national origin
- To see work-authorization documents before the legally required stage

Sponsorship decisions must be based on approved company criteria and business needs.

27. Candidate Confidentiality

Candidate information is confidential and may be accessed only by individuals participating in an authorized hiring process.

Candidate information may include:

- Résumés
- Applications
- Contact information
- Interview notes
- Assessment results
- Compensation expectations
- Accommodation information
- Reference information

- Background-check information
- Work-authorization information

Employees must not:

- Share résumés in public or unrestricted channels
- Discuss candidates with unauthorized coworkers
- Download records to personal devices
- Use candidate information for personal networking or sales
- Contact candidates outside the authorized process
- Retain candidate data in private notes after the process ends
- Disclose confidential feedback to the candidate or referring employee

Medical, accommodation, background-check, and work-authorization information should receive heightened protection.

28. Candidate Communications

Candidates should receive clear and professional communication about:

- Application receipt, where supported
- Interview scheduling
- Assessments
- Accommodation requests
- Significant delays
- Offers
- Rejections
- Background-check procedures
- Required notices

Recruiters should avoid:

- Making misleading promises
 - Stating that an offer is guaranteed before approval
 - Disclosing another candidate's information
 - Providing unapproved legal advice
 - Describing protected characteristics as factors in the decision
 - Arguing with rejected candidates
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29. Internal Candidates

Internal candidates should be evaluated according to job-related criteria.

Their current manager must not retaliate against them for applying to another role.

Internal hiring processes may consider:

- Current performance
- Relevant experience
- Skills
- Disciplinary status
- Business transition requirements
- Eligibility under internal-transfer guidelines

Confidential employee-relations or medical information should not be shared with an interview panel unless lawfully necessary for the decision.

30. Former Employees and Rehires

Former employees may be considered for rehire based on:

- Previous performance
- Separation circumstances
- Rehire eligibility
- Current qualifications
- Business need
- Legal or policy restrictions

A former employee must still complete the required application and selection process unless Human Resources approves an alternative internal process.

Rehire eligibility information is confidential and may be accessed only by authorized personnel.

31. Third-Party Recruiters and Staffing Agencies

External recruiters and staffing agencies must:

- Follow SnowyKim's approved job criteria
- Use approved compensation ranges
- Avoid prohibited salary-history inquiries
- Follow applicable fair-chance requirements
- Protect candidate information
- Provide required notices
- Avoid discriminatory sourcing or screening
- Use only approved assessment and technology tools
- Return or delete candidate information when required

SnowyKim may suspend a vendor that fails to comply with these requirements.

32. Recruitment Records

Recruitment records may include:

- Requisitions
- Job descriptions
- Job postings
- Applications
- Résumés
- Screening notes
- Interview feedback
- Assessment results
- Candidate communications
- Offer approvals
- Background-check documentation
- Selection rationale
- Accommodation records

Records must be maintained according to SnowyKim's retention schedule and applicable law.

Hiring participants must not:

- Delete records to conceal a decision
- Alter interview notes after a complaint
- Maintain undisclosed shadow files
- Preserve candidate records indefinitely without an approved purpose
- Store hiring records solely in personal email or personal notes

Accommodation and medical information should be stored separately or access-restricted.

33. Complaints and Escalation

Applicants and employees may report concerns about:

- Discrimination
- Harassment
- Retaliation
- Prohibited interview questions
- Inaccurate job postings
- Missing or misleading pay information
- Salary-history inquiries
- Background-check procedures
- Accommodation handling
- Automated hiring tools
- Candidate privacy

Reports may be sent to:

Human Resources

hr@snowykim-demo.com

Recruiting Operations

recruiting@snowykim-demo.com

Privacy Office

privacy@snowykim-demo.com

SnowyKim prohibits retaliation against a person who raises a good-faith concern or participates in a review.

34. Policy Violations

Violations may result in:

- Removal from an interview panel
- Cancellation or reassignment of a hiring process
- Mandatory training
- Removal of system access
- Corrective action
- Termination of vendor access
- Disciplinary action, up to and including termination
- Legal or contractual action where appropriate

Human Resources may invalidate or repeat a hiring stage when the process did not comply with this policy.

35. Policy Administration

Human Resources owns this policy and may issue supporting:

- Interview guides
- Requisition forms
- Job-description templates
- Evaluation rubrics
- Accommodation procedures
- Background-check procedures
- Offer-approval matrices
- Data-retention schedules
- Automated-tool review procedures

This policy may be revised to reflect:

- Legal changes
- Regulatory guidance
- New office locations
- New recruiting systems
- Audit findings
- Operational needs

Demonstration disclaimer: SnowyKim, its employees, email addresses, job opportunities, and procedures are fictional. This policy was created for HR-system and chatbot testing. It is not legal advice and should be reviewed by qualified employment counsel before real-world use.